

A man of many talents

Galileo was a polymath, which means that he was good at lots of things! He wrote poetry, played music, painted pictures, and studied medicine. Mathematics was his favorite subject though, and he used it to solve real-world problems. For example, he figured out that things didn't stop moving because they ran out of pushing force, but because friction slowed them down. Isaac Newton based his first two laws of motion on Galileo's discoveries. We still use these laws today to understand how all kinds of objects move.

Galileo used a telescope to observe the moon. He drew maps of the craters on its surface.

Experiments helped Galileo to find out why objects move as they do. For example, he proved that when objects are flung through the air, they travel in a smooth, curved shape, called a parabola.

Galileo rolled metal balls down ramps to measure how objects speed up as they fall.

It is a beautiful and delightful sight to behold the body of the moon.

There were no reliable clocks in Galileo's day, so he often used his own pulse to measure time. He described how a clock might use a swinging pendulum to keep time, but he died before his idea was proved right.